

Colin Kennedy

Lead Pipeline Developer

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📍 Los Angeles

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Engineer - Eyeline

March 2025-Present

- Building a RAG based semantic AI for proprietary workflows.
- Built a USD pipeline from scratch on very aggressive timelines.
- Coordinate interop between USD and Maya, cross departments.
- Mass refactored old codebases to improve code quality.
- Advise USD committee on best practices and USD tooling.
- Manage diverse expectations from developers and stakeholders
- Led thorough code reviews across multiple teams.

Pipeline Lead - The Mill

Jan 2023-Feb 2025

- Supported and nurtured my team of six.
- Architected and built a Linux+USD+ftrack pipeline rewrite.
- Stood up a Windows-Qt pipeline from zero in < 1 month.
- Created & led P4-backed Unreal + Cinema4D pipeline.
- Devised a cross-package auto-conversion tool.
- Regularly collaborated with DevOps to improve CI/CD.
- Transitioned Maya pipeline from Python 2 to 3.
- Continually put out urgent production fires on-call.

Pipeline Developer - The Mill

June 2021-2023

- Authored an advanced USD Ar 2.0 resolver for in-situ edits.
- Developed a tool in 8 days to deliver a \$10M project on-time.
- Built a suite of USD APIs for cross-functional partners.
- Reduced CG render times from 3 hours to 10 minutes.
- Enabled tech artists to self-publish code and Qt-PySide UIs.
- Ported over 50 tools between package managers.
- Solved studio-wide "Maya anti-virus" issue.
- Made a Jira ticket submitter - Auto-includes reports, tool profiling, scene metrics, and anything people on support would need.

EDUCATION

Savannah College

BFA – Visual Effects

2014-2016

Ringling College

BFA – Computer Animation

2011-2013

SOFTWARE

Python, C++
Maya, Houdini
Qt, PySide, PyQt
Nuke, Unreal Engine
Arnold, RenderMan
Ftrack, Shotgun
Linux, Windows
Neovim, Bash
Git, Perforce
SQL, Kibana
ComfyUI

CORE SKILLS

3D Tools Pipeline
Pipeline Architecture
Toolchain Fortification
Multi-OS CI/CD
Monitoring & Metrics
Cost & Risk Analysis
AGILE / Scrum
Programming
Homemade Hummus

Personal Achievements

2016-2025

- Eagle Scout. Built a 5 ton bridge that floats on water (Woodcock Nature Center, Wilton CT)
- Author of the USD-Cookbook, one of the most popular USD-related open-source projects on GitHub written in C++ and Python.
- Wrote 3 tree-sitter grammars for USD, objdump, and disassembly.
- Made dozens of Vim/Neovim plugins.
- Researching plausible pixel workflows for AI-driven 3D visuals
- Researching a specialized AI auto-completer

Asset TD - Animal Logic

March 2019-2021

- Built real-time validation framework for USD shots, sets, models, surfacing, and other USD assets that is run over 60,000 times per year.
 - Automated per-department reporting and summaries.
 - Global Kibana "production health" visualizations.
 - Mixed data & discipline validation.
 - Auto-detect issues and generate Shotgun ticket to fix.
- Collaborated with Toolchain team to deploy automated tests, linting, documentation, and PyPI package to all departments
- Created and maintained studio's USD Houdini pipeline.
- Wrote optimizer for point-instanced massive USD sets.

Pipeline TD - Crafty Apes

August 2018-2019

- Created a custom Aspera transfer tool using Qt and Pyro.
- Designed a fast and easy-to-use Shotgun and Rez-based asset pipeline.
- Devised a time-tracking tool that gives real-time project cost updates.
- Trained the team in Pipeline practices and workflows.

Pipeline Developer - MPC

July 2016-2018

- Created the studio's core Maya render-submission tool.
- Transitioned the rendering pipeline from V-Ray to Arnold.
- Programmed an ftrack-GPU Cache pipeline in Maya.
- Made import/export tools for a new ftrack-Nuke pipeline.
- Added asset-dependency tracking systems all DCCs
- Overhauled the validation system with Pyblish.
- Held open on-site support, resolving dozens of tickets a month on top of other responsibilities.